The Work of the Holy Spirit

Purpose: *To show how the spirit works on you & in you to bring about conversion.*
Centered on: The work of the Holy Spirit

Picture this: Jesus has spent 3.5 years with his disciples, they have become very close to one another and Jesus is telling them he is going to die, that he is going to be raised, he is going to ascend to heaven and they will no longer be in direct proximity to Him.

John 16: 6-8… According to verse 7, Jesus said it is to your advantage that I'm leaving.

Question: for what reason?

Answer: In order to send the Holy Spirit, to convict the **world** of sin and of righteousness and of judgment.

John 16: 9-11… **Question:** According to the text, why does the spirit convict of sin?

Answer: Because they do not believe. (The intended result of that sense of conviction is faith in Jesus Christ).

Question: According to the text, why does the spirit convict us of righteousness?

Answer: Because Jesus goes to his father & we see him no more. (Jesus was the perfect living embodiment of what righteousness looked like).

Question: Why does he convict of judgment?

Answer: because the ruler of this world is judged.

If God doesn't let Satan off the hook, why would he let us off the hook if we are playing on the same team? Remember, Lucifer was at one time in a perfect relationship with his creator. Lucifer at some point chose to rebel against God which eventually led to him being cast out of heaven.

Ephesians 1: 13-14… The word of truth is the Gospel and your response is to believe.

Question: What happens next?

Answer: You are sealed with the promised Holy Spirit.

Question: What is the function of a seal?

Answer: To preserve its contents.

So this text says…you hear the word, you believe in Christ when you hear the word and when that happens, the spirit of God comes into your life and seals you. As we find in verse 14, the seal is to

guarantee in the present that something important is going to happen in the future. That you will get the eternal inheritance that God has promised you.

- ***Galatians 3: 1-11…***You heard the message, and you believed it.
- ***Acts 5: 32…***The obedience mentioned here is not obedience to regiments or laws essentially, but rather obedience to God in believing in and receiving the Messiah.

Romans 8: 14-16…Not only am I the guarantee that you are going to make it, but I am going to assure you that you are my son/daughter.

- ***Galatians 3: 26…*** **Question:** According to this text, how does someone become a son of God?
  Answer: through faith in Christ Jesus.
- ***Galatians 4: 6…***What is the result of being a son? (Crying out to the Father)
- ***Galatians 5: 22, 23…***You need the spirit to gain victory!

Romans 8: 1-8…Prepositional statements. If you can remove a certain word or phrase out of a sentence and the sentence still holds its intended meaning, then this aspect of the sentence is regarded as a prepositional statement. We find an example of this in verse 2 . If we remove all the extraneous stuff from verse 2, it simply states: **"the Law has made me free"!** What does this mean?

We find in verse 1, there is now **No Condemnation for those in Christ!**

#1 No condemnation…. The good news of the gospel is that Christ came to condemn sin, not sinners (John 3:17; Rom. 8:3). To those who believe and accept the generous provisions of the gospel and who in faith commit themselves to lives of loving obedience, Christ offers justification and freedom. There may yet be deficiencies in the believer's character, but "when it is in the heart to obey God, when efforts are put forth to this end, Jesus accepts this disposition and effort as man's best service, and He makes up for the deficiency with His own divine merit"

Why?....verse 2 states , The law has made me free! This is not suggesting that the law is no longer the standard of behavior, but rather the condemnation that the law brought to me because of my sin is no longer binding. The law has basically relinquished its claim on me as a sinner. The reason for this is stated in verse 3, **our condemnation happened when Christ was condemned!** Christ's death caused the law to relinquish its claim on us.

#2 What the law could not do….God has accomplished what the law has been unable to do. He has condemned sin, and thus it is possible for the Christian to overcome its power, and to live a triumphant life in Christ.

#3 Weak through the flesh….This cause of failure has already been explained in ch. 7:14–25. The law can point out the right way, but it cannot enable weak, fallen man to walk in it. Paul continues to vindicate the law (see ch. 7:7, 10, 13, 14), ascribing its apparent weakness not to any defect inherent in the law itself but rather to the impotence of man's nature, corrupted and enfeebled by sin. It is not the function of law to pardon and to restore to obedience. Law can only reveal transgression and righteousness and command obedience (chs. 3:20; 7:7). Therefore, the law of God cannot be blamed or despised for not accomplishing results for which it never was designed. Our failure to render perfect obedience must be blamed upon ourselves.

Hebrews 10: 15-17…Notice the Holy Spirit in the new covenant promise, is going to write his law on your heart and on your mind. This was foretold by the prophet Jeremiah.

Jeremiah 31: 31-34…In Jeremiah, Gods people were in Babylonian exile and God was promising to end their exile at the time of the new covenant. That is the forgiveness of their sins and the writing of the law on their hearts. At the end of the seventy years, the Israelites were taken out of Babylon yet no new covenant was implemented! Even though Israel was "out of Babylon" and physically out of exile….they still remained spiritually in exile. This was because they were not experiencing the new covenant! So when Jesus came and announced redemption and deliverance, the apostles began to preach the new covenant promise *"the forgiveness of sins and the writing of the law on the heart*" what the apostles were actually announcing was the end of Israel's captivity!

Romans 8: 4…Therefore, when a person becomes a believer, the spirit of God comes in and says I'm your guarantee you're going to heaven. You are my son/daughter, now let me teach you how to live as my child. The spirit of God begins to fulfill the righteous requirement of the Law in your life.

#4 Might be fulfilled…. God sent His Son in the likeness of sinful flesh, so that men might be enabled fully to comply with the righteous requirements of His holy law. To bring man's life into harmony with the divine will is the purpose of the plan of salvation. God did not give His Son in order to change or abolish His law, or to release men from the necessity of perfect obedience. The law has always stood as an expression of the unchangeable will and character of God. Fallen man has been unable to obey its requirements, and the law has possessed no power to strengthen him to obey. But now Christ has come to make it possible for man to render perfect obedience. These verses clearly indicate the continuing place and authority of the law of God in the gospel and the plan of salvation (see ch. 3:31). Paul does not say, "Might be ***partially*** fulfilled." The Bible consistently speaks of entire transformation, perfect obedience (see Matt. 5:48; 2 Cor. 7:1; Eph. 4:12, 13; Col. 1:28; 4:12; 2 Tim. 3:17; Heb. 6:1; 13:21). God requires perfection of His children, and the perfect life of Christ in His humanity is God's assurance to us that by His power we too may attain to perfection of character.

Romans 8: 4-8…Notice in verse 4, it says that those who are living according to the spirit have the righteous requirement of the Law fulfilled in them.

Question: According to verse 6, if you set your mind on the flesh, what is it going to result in?

Answer: Death.

Question: If you set your mind on the spirit, what will it result in?

Answer: Life.

Question: Why does the mind set on the flesh lead to death according these verses?

Answer: Because the mind that is set on the flesh is at enmity with God (verse 7) and therefore cannot please God! (verse 8).

Question: Why is the carnal mind at enmity with God?

Answer: Because it cannot submit to Gods law (verse 7).

Galatians 5: 19-24… Interestingly, Romans 8 uses "law language" it says basically, if you live in the flesh you're going to die! Because you're a rebel against Gods law! But if you're in the spirit, God will fulfill the law in your life. Hebrews 10 states God will write the law on your heart & on your mind. Then here in Galatians 5 he lists all of these unattractive ways of living and then says God has another way of living and that is in the spirit! These are the two options before us.

John 14: 15-16… note the keeping of the commandments can only be possible through the assistance of God. ***Grace and Law do not oppose but rather coincide.***